AA-R-20a
JULY 1, 1959
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. AA-R-0020 (GSA-FSS)
June 10, 1957 and
Fed. Spec. AA-B-566
February 15, 1950

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

RACK, DISPLAY, BOOK, (WOOD)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. — The Federal Standard wood display racks covered by this specification are intended for use in general or executive offices and courtrooms. They are intended to hold books or other working material for ready reference in preference to a bookcase or supplemental to a bookcase.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and styles.*—The display racks covered by this specification shall be of the types and styles, as specified.

Type I:

Style A.—Standard rack without casters.
Style B.—Standard rack with casters.

Type II.—Executive office type rack.

1.2.2 *Colors of finish.* — Colors of finish shall be as specified and shall match the following standard colors adopted by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration:

Light Oak
Walnut
Grey

(Sample panels of the standard colors of finish are obtainable without charge from the Business Service Center, Regional Office Building, General Services Administration, Washington 25, D. C., or from the Business Service Center of the nearest General Services Administration Regional Office.)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

Federal Specifications:

FF-C-82—Casters, Swivel, Chair.
TT-L-57—Lacquer, Rubbing, Clear (for Wood Furniture).
MMM-A-100—Adhesive, Animal Gelatin.
MMM-A-125 — Adhesive, Casein-Type, Water- and Mold-Resistant.
MMM-A-188 — Adhesive; Urea-Resin-Type (Liquid and Powder).
PPP-B-636—Boxes, Fiber.
PPP-T-60 — Tape; Pressure Sensitive Adhesive, Waterproof—for Packaging and Sealing.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 124 — Color of Painted Metal General Office Furniture.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards,

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL–L–10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedure and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. — The material used in the construction of the racks shall be the kind and quality specified herein.

3.1.1 *Adhesives.*—The adhesives to be used and their application shall be as shown in table I.

3.1.1.1 The adhesive manufacturer's directions for mixing and handling adhesives shall be accurately followed so as to result in maximum bondage.

TABLE I.—*Adhesives*

Kind of adhesive	Permitted use
Animal gelatin, Fed. Spec. MMM–A–100, Grade A1 or J2 Casein-type, Fed. Spec. MMM–A–125 Urea-resin-type, Fed. Spec. MMM–A–188	All assembly joints and built-up stock

3.1.2 *Hardware.*

3.1.2.1 *Glides.*—Glides for all type I, style A, and type II racks shall be of the rubber-cushioned nail type, made of steel not less than 0.050 inch thick, which shall be hardened, after forming, to at least 35 on the Rockwell C scale. The overall diameter of the glides shall be not less than $1\frac{1}{16}$ inch. There shall be no metal-to-metal contact after the glides are applied, and the glide shall have a substantially flat bottom. Glides shall have an oxidized copper finish or may be nickel or chromium plated.

3.1.2.2 *Casters.*—Type I, style B racks shall be fitted with four casters. The casters shall conform to type III (ball-bearing swivel), class 1 or 2, size B (2-inch diameter), and wheel composition material 1 (hard-rubber-composition with soft-rubber tread) of Federal Specification FF–C–82. They shall be installed 2 inches from front and back of cabinet to center of caster socket.

3.1.3 *Wood.*

3.1.3.1 *Characteristics.*—All exposed wood surfaces and edges of the racks shall be clean, well machined, well sanded and free from stains, discolorations, knots, worm holes, splits, shakes, checks, warp or any other defects which affect the finished appearance or serviceability.

3.1.3.2 *Seasoning.*—All wood parts shall be kiln-dried to a moisture content of from 5 to

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

8 percent, and after kiln-drying shall be properly conditioned to insure uniform distribution of moisture among the individual pieces. After edge gluing, built-up panels shall be permitted to cure sufficiently to insure uniform distribution of glue joint moisture and elimination of sunken joints, spring back and stresses that impair serviceability or finished appearance. All wood parts shall be from 5 to 8 percent moisture content at time of assembly.

3.1.3.3 *Varieties.*—The wood to be used in any one rack for the color of finish specified, shall be as shown in table II. The manufacturer may bid either genuine or imitation walnut finish when walnut color of finish is specified.

TABLE II.—*Species of wood*

Color of finish		Species of wood
Light oak		Oak
Walnut	Genuine	Walnut
	Imitation	Beech Birch Cherry Maple Pecan

3.1.4 *Lacquer.*—Lacquer shall conform to test requirements of type I or type II lacquer of Federal Specification TT–L–57.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 *Design.* — The design of the racks shall be as shown in figures 1 and 2 for type I, and figures 3 and 4 for type II.

3.2.2 *Tolerances.* — The following tolerances will be permitted:

Overall width: Plus or minus ⅛ inch.
Overall depth: Plus or minus ⅛ inch.
Overall height: Plus or minus ⅛ inch.
Thickness of any wood part: plus 1/16, minus 1/32 inch.

3.2.3 *End panels.*—The end panels shall be of full length solid wood strips not greater than 6 inches or less than 2 inches wide, except one edge strip may be not less than 1 inch wide. The solid wood strips shall be carefully selected for similar grain and color and shall be edge joined with either continuous tongue and groove construction or with matched square edge joints. The base reinforcing for type I racks shall be of solid wood ¾ inch thick, securely glued to the bottom inside the end panels and secured by wood screws as shown in figure 2. The base of the type II racks shall be formed by installing a molding to the end panels. The molding shall be made of solid wood, 7/16 inch thick, 3 inches wide and shaped as shown in figure 3. It shall be mitered all around and securely glued to the end panels.

3.2.4 *Troughs.*—Each trough member shall be of full length solid wood strips not greater than 6 inches or less than 2 inches wide, except one edge strip may be not less than 1 inch wide. The solid wood strips shall be carefully selected for similar grain and color and shall be edge joined with continuous tongue and groove construction. The trough members shall be joined together by tongue and groove and shall be tenoned on the ends to fit the mortises on the end panels. All pieces shall be securely glued.

3.2.5 *Pedestal type I racks.*—The bottom shelf and apron shall be of full length solid wood strips not greater than 6 inches wide or less than 2 inches wide, except one edge strip may be not less than 1 inch wide. The solid wood strips shall be carefully selected for similar grain and color and shall be edge joined with either continuous tongue and groove construction or with matched square edge joints. All pieces shall be securely glued.

3.3 Method of finishing.—All exposed surfaces shall be finish sanded and all corners and edges eased, and thoroughly cleaned. These surfaces shall be finished in accordance with the materials coating system and tests specified in Federal Specification TT–L–57.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Alternatively, other similar materials and coating systems meeting the tests specified in Federal Specification TT–L–57 may be acceptable. The finishing material or their application shall not cloud the natural grain of the wood. Bleaching agents shall not be used. The application of materials, drying time, sanding, cleaning and rubbing shall be controlled to produce smooth uniform exposed surfaces without blisters, pits, wrinkles, runs, tackiness or more than a trace of orange peel.

3.4 Identification marking. — Each rack shall be permanently and clearly marked in an inconspicuous place, with the Federal stock number, this specification number, the date of manufacture, and the contractor's or manufacturer's name or trademark so that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.5 Workmanship. — The details of construction, joining, assembly, and finishing shall be in strict accordance with the minimum requirements of this specification and equal in every respect not specified herein to the manufacturer's regular commercial production. Each item shall be free from any defects that affect the appearance or that might affect the serviceability of the lifetime of the furniture.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling for inspection.—Representative random samples shall be selected from the lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.2 Inspection. — The racks shall be inspected by the contractor to determine compliance with this specification as to workmanship, materials, design, details of construction, casters, finish, marking, packaging, and packing. Each item shall be subject to inspection by the Government. When inspection is made by the Government at place of manufacture, all reasonable facilities and assistance required by the inspector in the performance of his duty for safe and convenient inspection, shall be provided by the contractor without cost to the Government.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Nonmilitary agencies.—Federal Standard No. 102 should be referred to for definitions and application of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.)

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 *Level A.*—Casters shall be removed and placed in a draw-string type cotton cloth bag. The closed bag shall be secured within the rack.

5.1.2 *Level C.*—The rack shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's normal practice.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 *Level A.*—Each rack shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container constructed, closed, and strapped to conform to class 2, V3c or V3s, of Federal Specification PPP–B–636. Each shipping container shall be provided with a type I or II, grade B or C, class 2 sealed case-liner conforming to Military Specification MIL–L–10547. As an alternate, corners and joints of the shipping container may be sealed by the application of minimum 3 inch width tape conforming to type I or II, class 1 of Federal Specification PPP–T–60.

5.2.2 *Level B.*—Each rack shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container constructed to conform to type I or II, class 1 of Federal Specification PPP–B–636. All flaps of the fiberboard containers shall be securely sealed with an adhesive commercially used for the specific product being packed by application throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps, or by a combination of metal stitching the bottom flaps and sealing the top flaps with adhesive.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.3 *Level C.* — The racks, packaged as specified in 5.1.2, shall be packed in a manner acceptable to common carriers for safe transportation to point of destination specified in shipping instructions at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies.

5.2.4 *Level D.*—Racks shall be packed in containers which together with packaging, wrapping and inner packing are acceptable by ocean going vessels for safe transportation to the points of destination specified in the shipping instructions at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.*—Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* — Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.**—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) The type of item (see 1.2.1).
(*b*) The color (see 1.2.2).
(*c*) Level of packaging and level of packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(*d*) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 6.3).

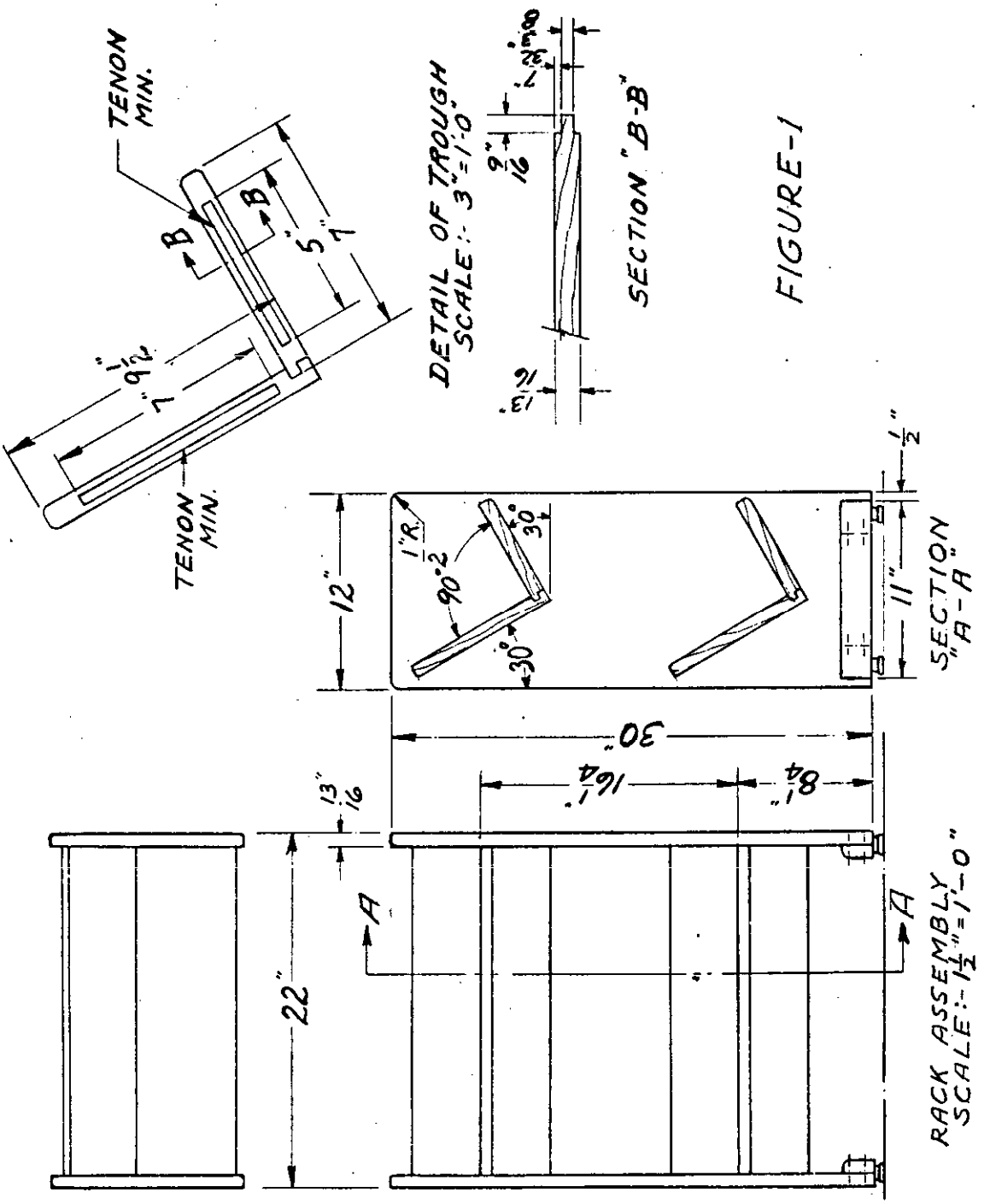
6.2 Federal Specifications do not include all the types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.3 **Preproduction sample.**—When specified in invitation to bid, and before production is commenced, a sample of each complete unit under contract shall be made available to the Contracting Officer or his representative for approval, either at the contractor's plant or at such other place as designated. When the preproduction sample is approved, it shall be retained by the inspector as a control guide for subsequent production on the contract. The approval sample may be included as a part of the last shipment.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army—Q
Navy— Y Or

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

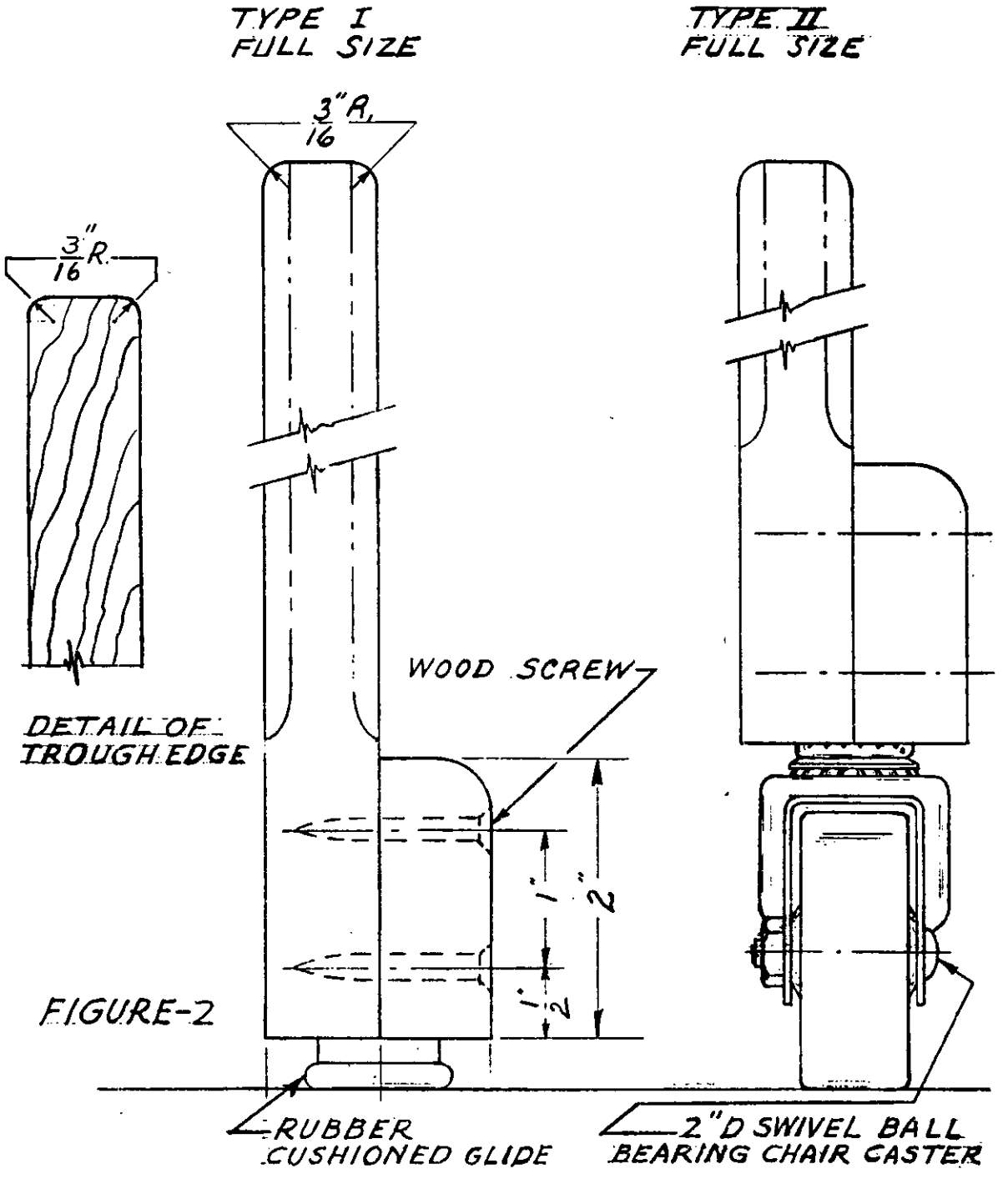
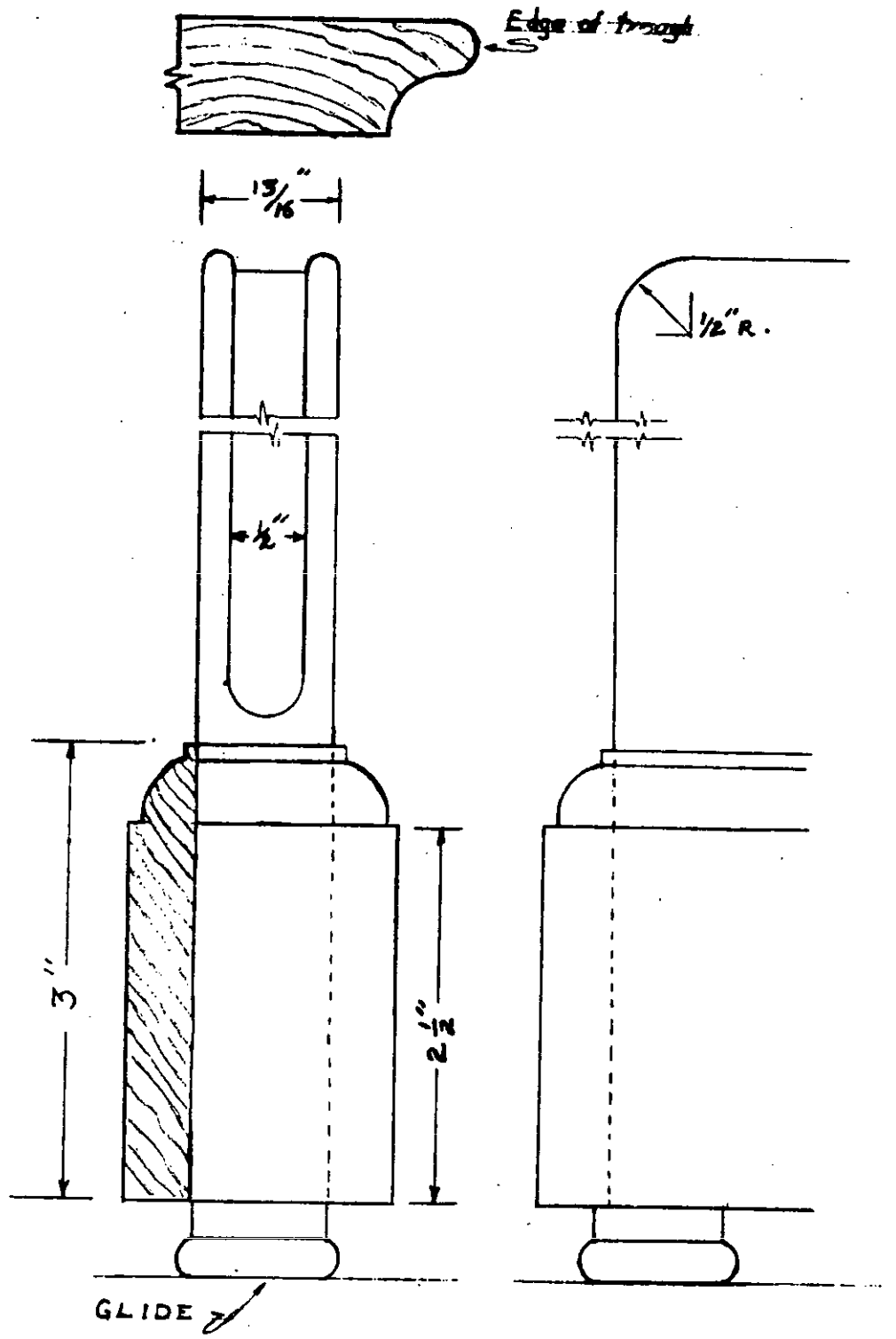


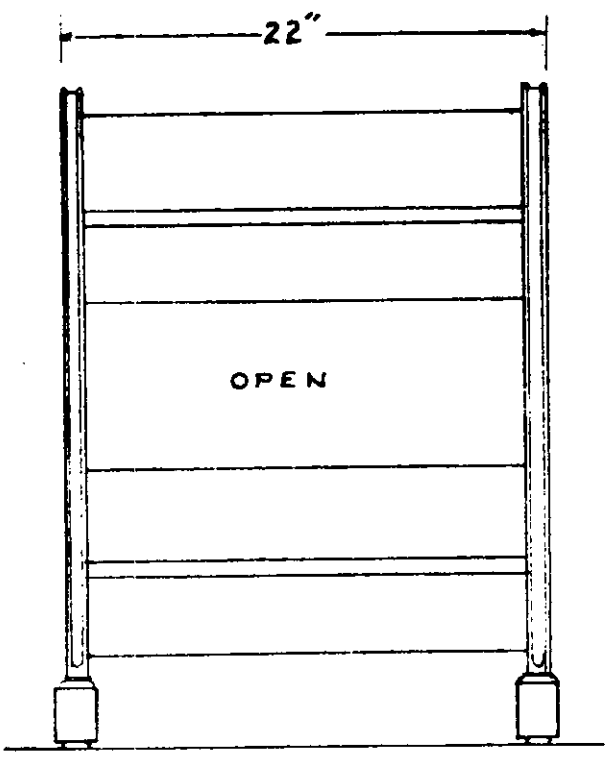
FIGURE-2

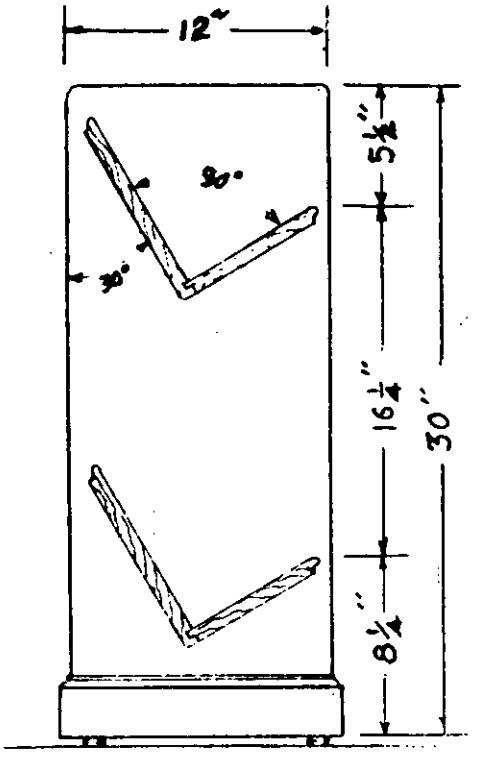
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

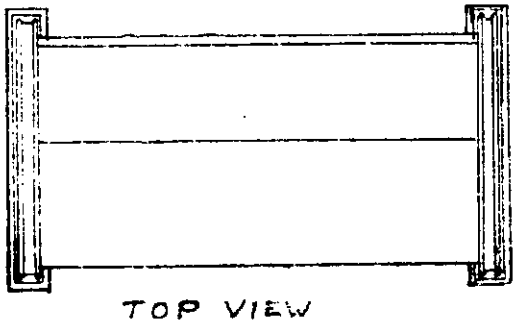


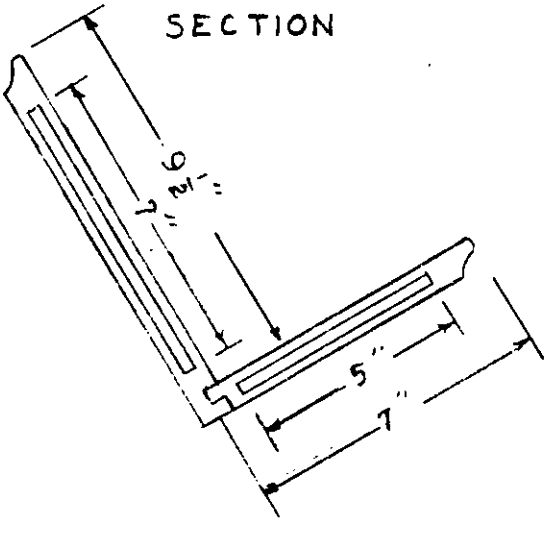
BOOK RACK
TYPE II

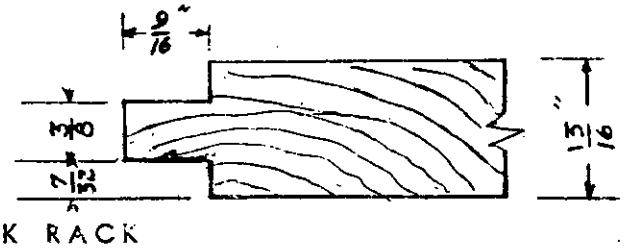
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.











BOOK RACK
TYPE II

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 10 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
NAVY DEPARTMENT

OFFICIAL BUSINESS

COMMANDER
DEFENSE GENERAL SUPPLY CENTER
ATTN: DGSCT-S
RICHMOND, VA. 23212

FOLD

PLATE NO. 15419 (BACK)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity *(as indicated on reverse hereof)*.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION *(Of submitter)*

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.

QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED

DOLLAR AMOUNT
$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 APR 63 1426 REPLACES NAVSHIPS FORM 4863, WHICH IS OBSOLETE C-8279

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.